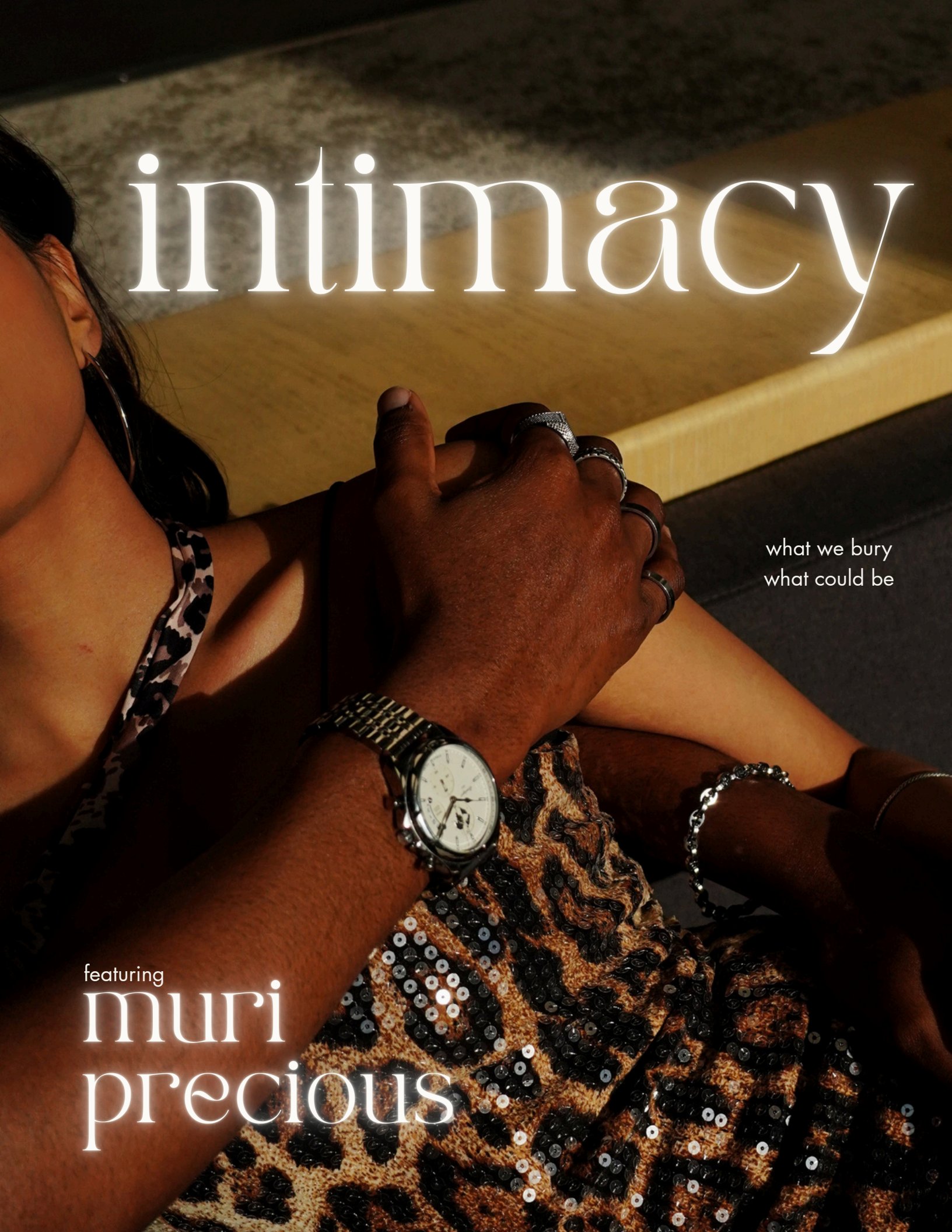

intimacy
what we bury
what could be
featuring
muri
precious

by murb

editor's note

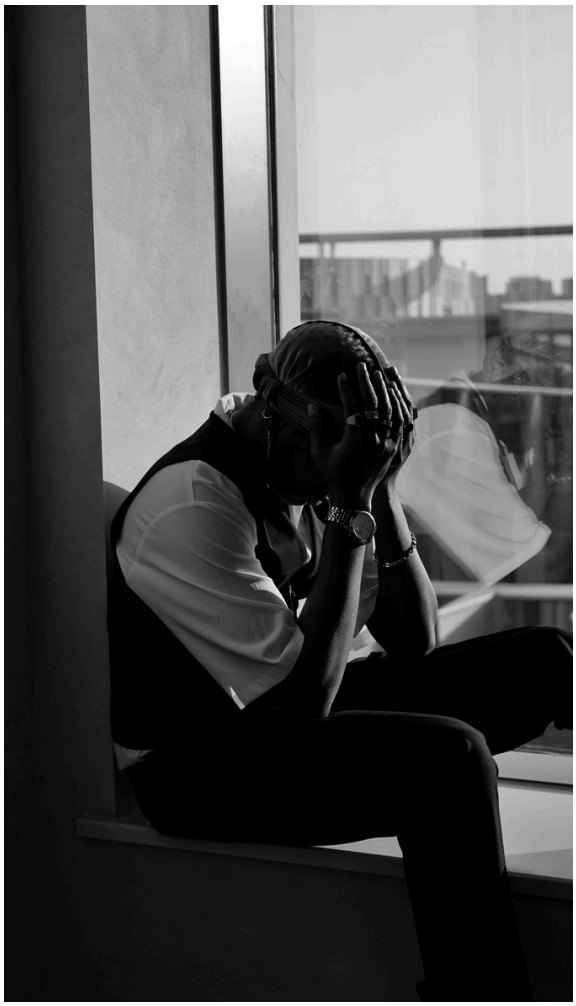
The book began as an observation I had towards how people chose to love. Not who they loved, but how: what they were willing to show, what they held back, and what they let go unsaid. Some of the loves I noticed were ones that, by most measures, shouldn't have existed. And yet the people in them spoke of closeness, of being understood, as if nothing were missing. Slowly, these observations became written paragraphs, which in turn became the questions behind these photographs.

We had all heard intimacy described as "into-me-see" which means being truly seen, and accepted. But what does that mean when the seeing is only partial? When someone knows you closely, but not completely? When the person you're hiding from is also yourself? If love can exist even when so much is held back or left unsaid, what does it mean to call intimacy "being truly seen"?

I don't have all the answers. Instead, I have photos and words written beside them, and I hope you'll sit with them and help connect the dots.

can we be *intimate* with each other
without being *intimate* with outselves?
and if we could, would it be kind?

a snake doesn’t choose when it outgrows its skin.
it only knows the old one has gone tight,
and the new one underneath will be soft for a while,
easy to wound.



to love is to see. ~~to love is to see to love is to see to love is to see

it hurts because the disguises come off slowly.

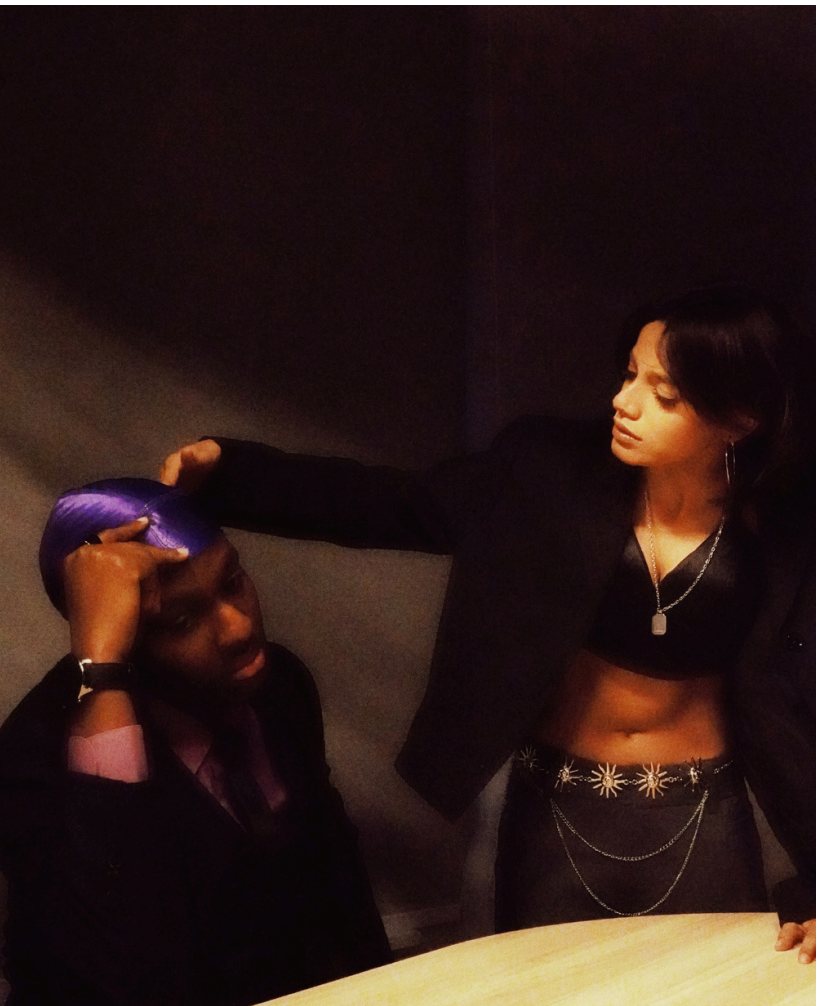
some we've worn so long,

we mistook them for our truth.

we let others see us,

only as far as we can bear to look.

but there is a love that asks the opposite.
it doesn't want your bare face;
it needs the mask kept on,
because it's the kind that shouldn't exist at all.



with every glance, with every touch,

we drift further from who we were.

thrilled by what's hidden,

by intentional ignorance,

the questions you decide not to ask.

deception is easy,

what's hard is keeping it up—

the mirror,

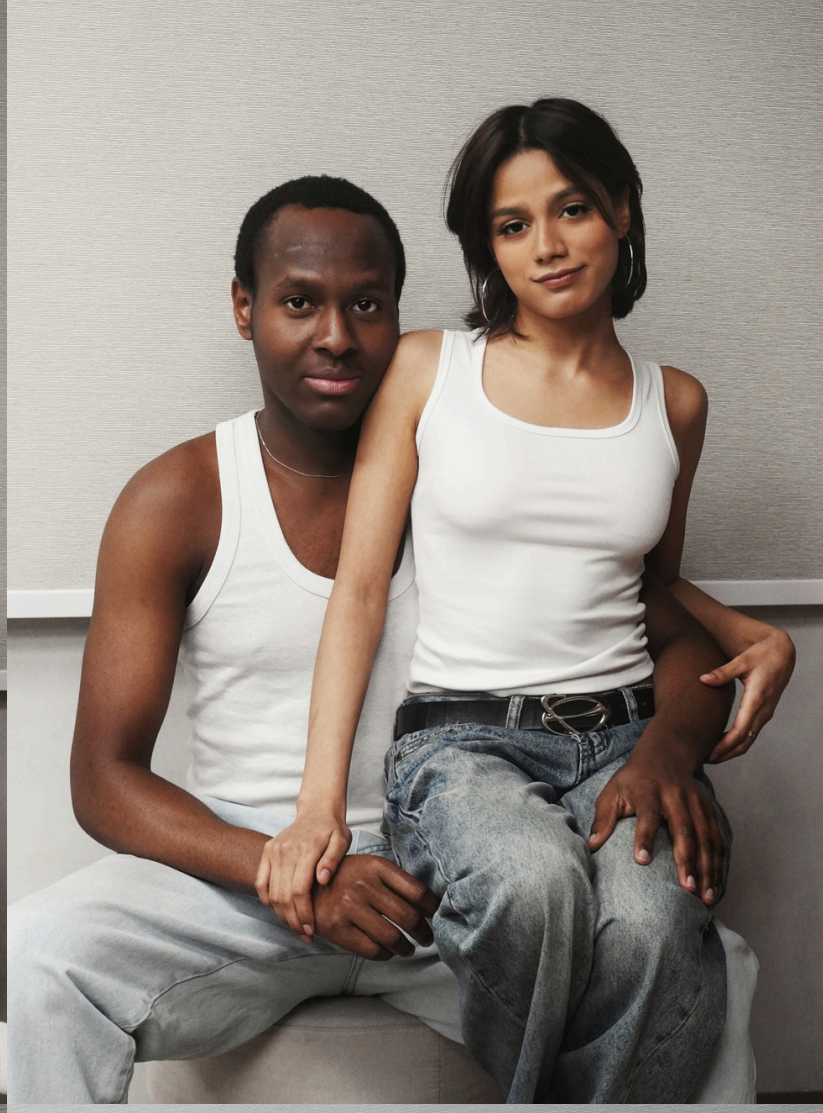
how quickly you learn to look away.

and still, it is intimacy;

you lay out all there is to see,

every part of you

except every part that knows.

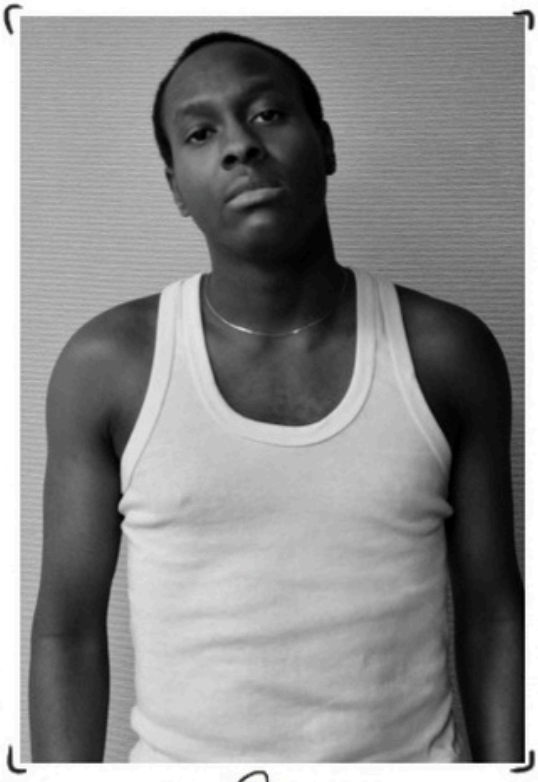


still, it is intimacy—

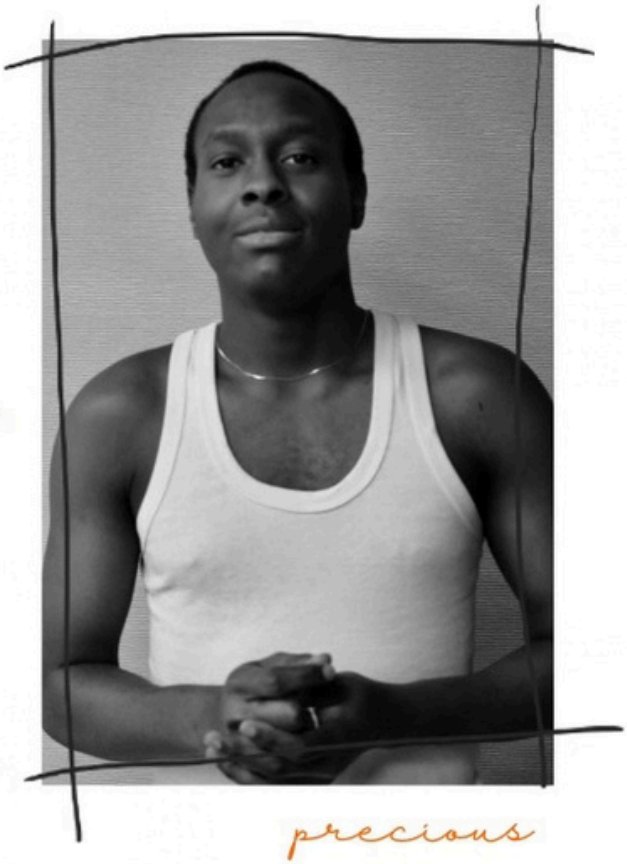
a skin you grow instead of shed,

a love too dangerous to name,

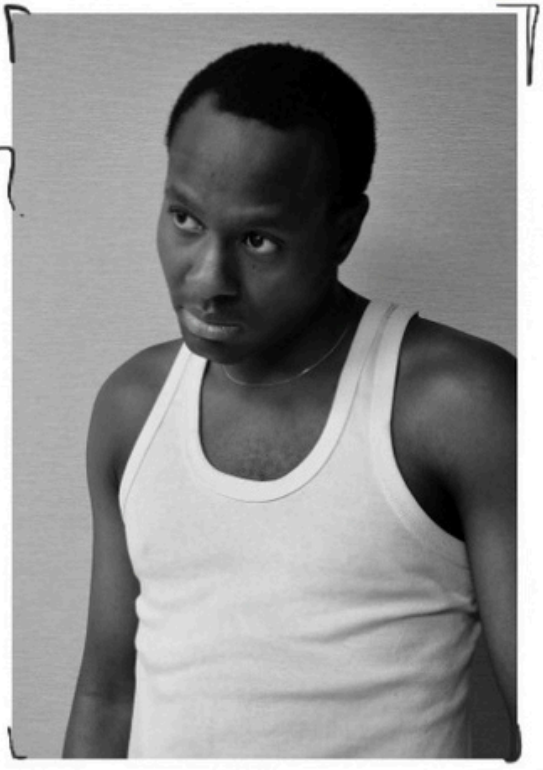
especially to yourself.

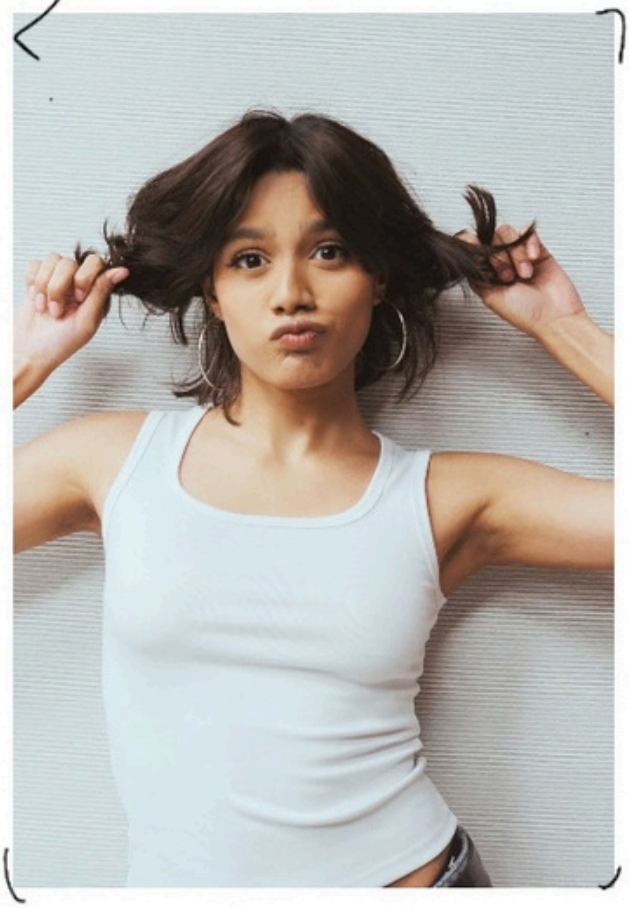


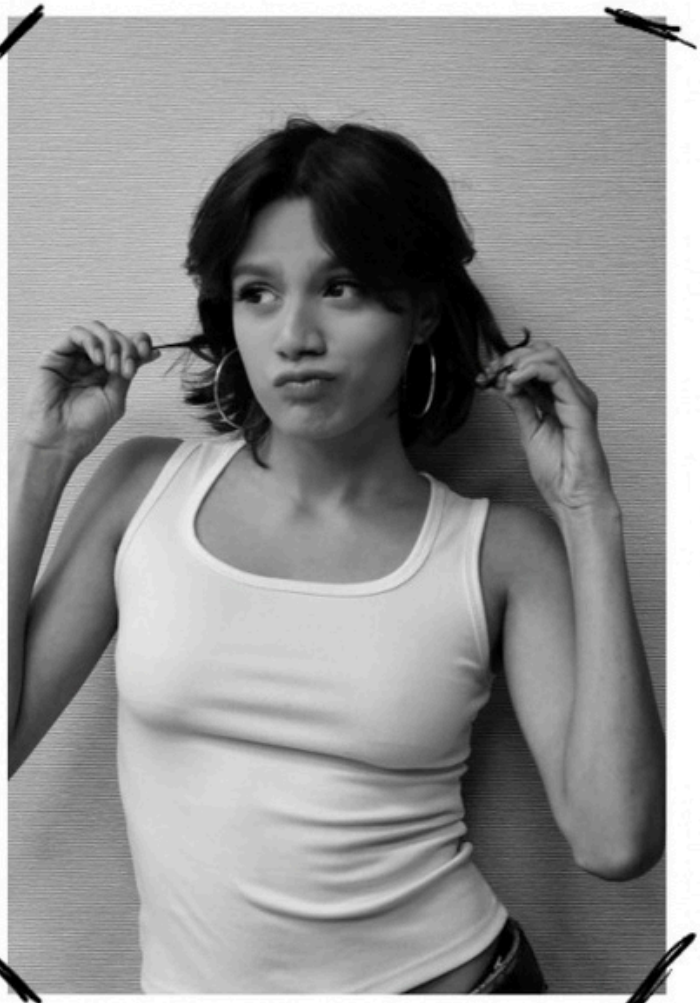
intimacy



precious







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acknowledgements

If you've reached the end of this book, congratulations and thank you!

A huge thank you to my friends, Precious and Muri, for agreeing to be a part of this project and bringing my vision to life! This would not have been possible without y'alls amazingness! MWAH! And thank you, Chi, for showing up to our shoot out of nowhere and offering your brilliant creative direction. Some of the best shots were taken because of you! Love u guys so much!

This was a really fun and challenging project. and I'm so happy to have turned it into a photobook I can keep and share with others!

Know that this won't be the last. Stay tuned for more!

with love,

murh

Editor-in-Chief & Creative Director

hey! I'm Cash, aka murb. I'm a twenty-something-year-old photographer based in the Philippines. I photograph anything I find pretty.

intimacy

issue 01

see more

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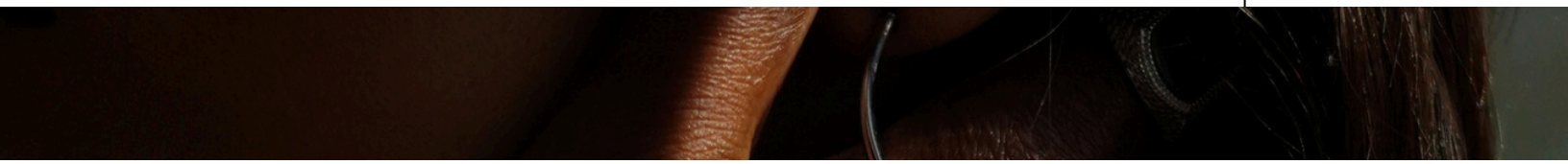

What does it mean when the seeing is only partial? When someone knows you closely, but not completely? When the person you're hiding from is also yourself?"

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